Garrett Summers
Bozeman, Montana

DATE October 27, 2026
RE Incident outside the Filling Station, Friday, October 23, 2026
911 CALL 26-158520
LATER CALLS 26-158660, 26-159664

An open letter on the incident outside the Filling Station

To the Bozeman community and the Bozeman Police Department,

On Friday, October 23, outside the Filling Station, I saw two women being hit with snowballs thrown by a group of men. The women said no, and they continued to be hit. Other people who saw it told me the snowballs had rocks in them. That is what led me to call 911.

First, my role, because it has been misunderstood. I am not affiliated with the Filling Station and have never worked for it. That night I was there as the promoter for the opening band, whom I had invited from Boulder to perform. I wanted to look out for the bands and the audience, so I wore a blazer and slacks and helped anyone who asked. I believe that is why the two women turned to me: they assumed I was with the venue. I was not.

I went to the group of men and confronted them. They did not take responsibility, and instead of apologizing, they ran off. I was hit by a snowball myself, but I was not the target, and I would not have called anyone on my own behalf. I called because the women were the ones being targeted. With no standing of my own as a victim, and with the men gone, I believed the police were the safest form of recourse.

Afterward I spoke with a sergeant. As I understood that conversation, the matter was not classified as a crime, and had the women placed the call themselves, it likely would have been treated as at least disorderly conduct. I have not seen the report.

I want to be clear about what this letter is not. It is not an accusation against any named person, and I ask that no one try to identify or name anyone in response. It makes no claim against the Filling Station or its staff. It does not claim that the police acted improperly: officers make these decisions with information I do not have. And it is not about snowballs, which are part of life in Bozeman. My concern is that people kept throwing them at two women who had said no, and the reports that some contained rocks. If the rock reports were examined and not supported, I want to know that too, and I will say so.

I am asking the Bozeman Police Department, through its normal processes, to confirm whether the reports of rocks were examined, and to explain what a bystander should do when the people being targeted are not the ones who make the call. If a witness's report carries less weight than one from the person targeted, people in Bozeman should know that before they need it. I intend to request the related records through the City's public records process. The two women are the people this is about.

Since that night, some people in Bozeman's music community have connected me to this incident in ways that are not accurate. Setting the record straight about my own role is part of why I am writing, but it is the smaller part.

If anything here is inaccurate, please tell me and I will correct it, noting the date of the change. Firsthand accounts from anyone who was there are welcome.

Sincerely,

Garrett Summers